

Nattokinase

Dosage & Timing Guide

What Is Nattokinase

Nattokinase is an enzyme isolated from natto, a fermented soybean food, first identified in 1980 for its ability to break down fibrin — the structural protein involved in blood clot formation. It's studied for supporting the body's natural fibrinolytic activity and, in one published randomized trial, for a modest blood-pressure-lowering effect.

Standard Dosing

- Typical studied dose: 2,000 FU (Fibrinolytic Units) once or twice daily.
- Look for FU activity on the label — not just milligram weight, which does not reliably indicate potency.
- The NSK-SD strain is the one most consistently used in published human research.

Best Timing

- Take on an empty stomach — ideally 30–60 minutes before a meal or 2 hours after.
- Dietary protein can interfere with enzymatic activity, which is why timing matters more for nattokinase than for most supplements.
- If splitting into two doses, space them roughly 12 hours apart (e.g. morning and evening).

Who Should Avoid It

- Anyone taking blood-thinning medication (warfarin, apixaban, clopidogrel) — consult a physician first.
- Anyone with a bleeding disorder, or scheduled for surgery within two weeks.
- Pregnant or breastfeeding individuals.

What to Look For on a Label

- FU (Fibrinolytic Unit) activity disclosed, not just capsule weight in mg.
- NSK-SD strain named specifically, where possible.
- Third-party testing or a certificate of analysis available from the brand.
- Vegetarian/vegan capsule if that matters to you — most quality brands offer this.

A Simple Way to Start

Begin with a single 2,000 FU dose taken on an empty stomach in the morning. Reassess after 2–4 weeks. If you are on any cardiovascular medication, or have a bleeding-related condition, speak with your doctor before starting — nattokinase has mild anticoagulant activity and can interact with other blood-thinning treatments.

Disclaimer

This guide is educational and not medical advice. It does not replace consultation with a qualified healthcare provider, particularly if you take medication or have an existing health condition.